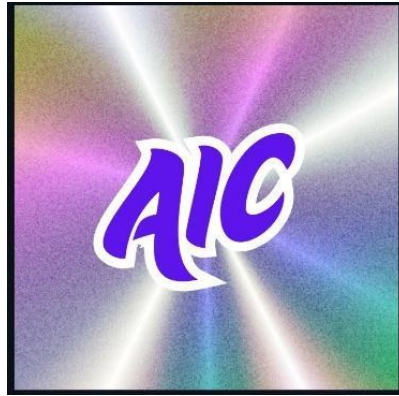




AI Marathon 2026 LLM Everywhere

ON

18th May 2026 - 6th June 2026

AT

Asia Pacific University



Organized By
APU AIC

Event Handbook

Table of Contents

Table of Contents.....	2
Introduction.....	3
Event Overview.....	4
Key Dates & Timeline.....	5
Event Activities.....	6
Event Workshops.....	7
Hackathon Challenge.....	8
Rules & Regulations.....	9
Eligibility.....	9
Participation.....	9
AI Usage Requirement.....	9
Technical Stack.....	9
Awards.....	9
Liability.....	10
Data Protection and Privacy.....	10
Intellectual Property.....	10
Judging Criteria.....	11
Submission Guidelines.....	13
Awards & Recognition.....	14
Contact Information.....	15

Introduction

Welcome to **AI Marathon 2026!**

Organized by the **Artificial Intelligence Club (AIC)** at **Asia Pacific University (APU)**, AI Marathon is an exciting event designed for students who are interested in exploring the world of Artificial Intelligence. With the theme “**LLM Everywhere,**” the event highlights how Large Language Models are transforming industries and creating new opportunities for innovation.

Throughout the AI Marathon, participants will take part in expert talks, hands-on workshops, interactive sessions, and a **hackathon challenge** where teams work together to develop creative AI solutions for real-world problems.

Whether you are new to AI or already experienced, this event is a great opportunity to **learn, collaborate, and build something meaningful together.**

We're excited to see the ideas and solutions you will create — **let's build the future of AI together!**

Event Overview

AI Marathon 2026 is a multi-day technology event organized by the **Artificial Intelligence Club (AIC) at Asia Pacific University (APU)**. The event brings together students, industry experts, and AI enthusiasts to explore the practical applications of Artificial Intelligence.

With the theme “**LLM Everywhere,**” AI Marathon focuses on how Large Language Models are transforming industries and enabling new AI-powered solutions. Participants will have the opportunity to attend expert talks, join hands-on technical workshops, and take part in interactive sessions designed to build both knowledge and practical skills.

The highlight of the event is the **Hackathon Challenge**, where participants work in teams to design innovative AI solutions for real-world problems. Teams will have a chance to present their ideas during the final pitching session.

AI Marathon aims to create a collaborative environment where students can **learn new technologies, build innovative ideas, and connect with the AI community.**

Key Dates & Timeline

Event Timeline	Date
Workshop Day 1	18th May 2026
Workshop Day 2	20th May 2026
Workshop Day 3	21st May 2026
Workshop Session by AIC RnD and Problem Statement Reveal	22nd May 2026
Final Project Submission	26th May 2026
Workshop Day 4	25th May 2026
Workshop Day 5	26th May 2026
Workshop Day 6	28th May 2026
Finalist Announcement	1st June 2026
Hackathon Top 10 Finals Pitching	6th June 2026

Event Activities

The following activities will be conducted during AI Marathon @ APU, designed to provide participants with both theoretical knowledge and practical exposure to **Large Language Models (LLMs)** under the theme “**AI Marathon 2026: LLM Everywhere**”.

Activity	Description	Target Skill Level
Talks & Knowledge Sharing Sessions	Expert-led talks exploring real-world applications of LLMs across industries: • LLM in Manufacturing: Smarter Automation” “Shaping the Next Cloud with LLMs • LLM in Finance: From Crypto to Compliance • Language Models is the new Medical Assistant • Scaling Your Conversation through LLMs Learning Outcomes: • Understand industry applications of LLMs. • Identify opportunities for real-world solutions.	Beginner - Intermediate
Hands-on Technical Workshops	Guided coding sessions, demonstrations of LLM-powered tools, and applied problem-solving activities under the supervision of industry professionals and APU academics. Learning Outcomes: • Gain practical skills in building simple LLM-based solutions and workflows.	Intermediate <i>(Basic programming knowledge required)</i>
Interactive Sessions	Activities such as Q&A sessions, panel discussions, quizzes, and audience challenges related to LLM topics, to encourage engagement with speakers and experts. Learning Outcomes: • Reinforce concepts from talks and workshops through discussion and interaction.	Beginner - Advanced <i>(open to all participants)</i>

Event Workshops

Date	Time	Workshop	Host	Mode	Venue
18 May 2026	18:30 - 20:45	What is DeAI & Why should you care?	Morpheus and APU DeAI Club	Physical	S-08-02
20 May 2026	13:30 - 15:30	Introducing Chutes, Bittensor and How to Build on Chutes	Chutes.AI	Hybrid	TBC
21 May 2026	18:30 - 20:30	Chutes and Agents: Creating Self Orchestrating Agents	Chutes.AI	Physical	S-08-02
22 May 2026	18:00 - 21:00	Beyond the Scan: From X-Rays to Clinical Understanding with Multimodal LLM	AIC RnD	Hybrid	S-08-01
25 May 2026	18:30 - 20:45	Hands-on Workshop with APU DeAI Club and Morpheus	Morpheus and APU DeAI Club	Physical	S-08-02
26 May 2026	13:30 - 15:30	LLM in Cloud Computing	AWS APU Club	Physical	S-08-02
28 May 2026	10:30 - 12:30	Transformers Explained: Simple Explanation of What's Behind the Black Box	Jeffry Christopher	Physical	S-08-01

Hackathon Challenge

The Hackathon Challenge serves as the **core experiential component of AI Marathon**, where participants apply knowledge gained from talks and workshops to develop innovative solutions using **Large Language Models (LLMs)**.

Participants will collaborate in teams to **design, prototype, and refine AI-powered solutions** within a limited development period. The **challenge problem statement will be revealed during the event**, allowing teams to apply insights gained earlier in the programme.

Problem statements will reflect **current industry trends and real-world applications of LLM technologies**, encouraging participants to develop practical and impactful solutions.

At the end of the hackathon, all teams will submit their projects for evaluation. **Top-performing teams will be selected as finalists and advance to the final pitching session**, where they will present their solutions after further refinement if needed.

Rules & Regulations

Eligibility

- Open to **students from any university** who have registered for AI Marathon.
- Participation in talks and workshops is **free**.
- Workshops are **intermediate-level**, requiring basic programming knowledge; talks are beginner-friendly.
- Participation in the hackathon is **optional** and requires **separate registration** with a designated fee.
- Teams can include members from **different institutions**.

Participation

- Teams may consist of **1 to 4** members. **Solo** participation is welcome.
- Participants can choose their **level of involvement** in talks, workshops, or the hackathon.
- Teams must register before the deadline; **team changes after registration are not permitted**.
- All participants are expected to follow a **code of conduct**: harassment, discrimination, or disruptive behaviour may result in disqualification.

AI Usage Requirement

- All submissions must incorporate **LLM & Agentic**.
- Solutions must use AI meaningfully to enhance functionality, efficiency, or impact.

Technical Stack

- Teams may use any **tools, frameworks, or APIs** relevant to their solution.
- Effective integration of AI and other technologies will be highly valued.

Awards

- All prizes must be **shared among team members** as per their mutual agreement.
- **Prizes are non-transferable** and may only be **claimed by the designated winner(s)**.

- The **decisions of the judges and organizers** regarding the **selection of winners are final and binding**, and **no appeals, disputes, or reconsiderations** will be accepted.

Liability

- Organizers reserve the right to **modify rules** without prior notice.
- Participants assume **all risks** related to participation.
- Organizers are not responsible for any **damage, loss, or injuries**.

Data Protection and Privacy

- Participant information will be **kept secure** and used only for event purposes unless consent is given.

Intellectual Property

- Participants retain **IP rights** to their projects.
- Teams grant organizers a **non-exclusive, royalty-free license** to showcase and promote projects for marketing and educational purposes.

Problem Statements/ Track

Select **ONE** of the following tracks based on your team's preference and track availability:

Problem Statement 1: The Autonomous Sales Engineer

Challenge: Most complex sales aren't about finding one item; they are about building a system. Whether it's a custom-built PC, a specialized camera rig for a film set, or a fully-fitted home office, the "Sales Engineer" must ensure all parts are compatible, fit the budget, and can be delivered to the client's specific location.

- **The Mission:** Build an **agent** that acts as a Technical Sales Consultant. The agent must take a high-level "Requirements Brief" from a client (e.g., "I need a minimalist home office for a 10x10ft room under RM5,000") and autonomously navigate a product catalog (like Walmart, IKEA, or a provided mock handbook) to design a complete, valid, and quoted solution.
- **Agentic Twist:** This isn't just a search engine; it's a Constraint Solver that may perform
 - Constraint-Based Discovery: The agent must search relevant platforms (e.g., Amazon, Walmart, Best Buy, or specialized industrial catalogs) to find components. It must autonomously reject items that violate the user's technical constraints (e.g., "This power supply isn't strong enough for this GPU").
 - Logistics & Fulfillment Reasoning: The agent can use location data to calculate the "Total Cost of Ownership," including shipping fees, estimated delivery times, and regional taxes.
 - Dynamic Quote Generation: The final output is a professional Sales Quotation/ Solution Proposal that includes key details such as itemized list of products with URLs, a "Reasoning Summary", and bill of materials.

Key Components: External Integration, Mathematical Precision (e.g., for discounts, taxes, and shipping fees without "hallucinating" numbers).

Problem Statement 2: The Intelligent Recruiter

Challenge: Traditional job boards are static. Your goal is to build an **agent** that bridges the gap between diverse talent and hiring managers.

- **The Mission:** Create an agent that takes a job description and a pool of candidate data (resumes/profiles) and identifies the best matches.
- **Agentic Twist:** The agent shouldn't just rank candidates; it should generate **personalized "Why this person?" pitches** for the recruiter and integration with platforms like **LinkedIn** (simulated or via API) is highly encouraged to fetch data or automate outreach.
- **Key Components:** Vector search for matching, personalized reasoning for pitches.

Problem Statement 3: The Global Treasury Agent

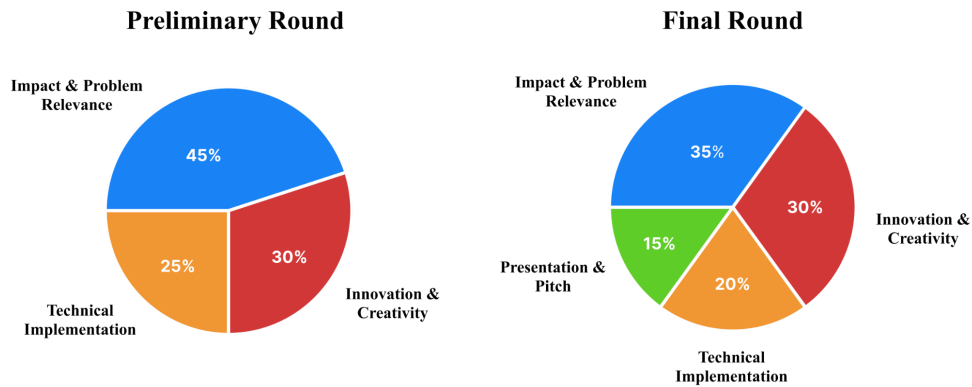
Challenge: Small to Medium Enterprises (SMEs) often struggle with "Cross-Border Reconciliation." They receive RM42.50 into their bank account, but the invoice was for USD10. Matching these manually involves calculating exchange rates, accounting for bank fees, and logging the results.

- **The Mission:** Build a reconciliation **agent** that processes payment proofs (images/PDFs) in various currencies and matches them against local bank statements.
- **Agentic Twist:** The agent must do more than just "identify" a match; it must execute the reconciliation workflow. For example, the agent can:
 - Perform Tool-Based Reasoning: Fetch FX rates to account for the exact date of the transaction and factor in common bank percentage fees.
 - Generate Actionable Artifacts: Upon successful matching, the agent can autonomously generate a Reconciliation Report.
 - Bridge the Gap: For unsolved discrepancies, the agent can generate a "Discrepancy Summary" or trigger a mock notification to the user explaining why the match failed.

Key Components: OCR for payment proofs, reasoning logic for matching, and tool-use (e.g., Google Workspace tools to store transaction files and transaction rules like bank fee config).

Judging Criteria

Evaluation Criteria Distribution



Evaluation Criteria Breakdown for Preliminary Round

[Detailed Judging Rubrics for Final Round](#)

CATEGORY A: IMPACT & PROBLEM RELEVANCE (45%)	
MAX POINTS	CATEGORIES
20 POINTS	Track Understanding & Completeness
	- Does the team demonstrate a good understanding of their chosen track's objective? - Does the solution cover the main tasks requested in the problem statement? - Does the agent produce meaningful outputs
15 POINTS	Solution Effectiveness
	- Does the proposed solution effectively address the identified problem? - Is the approach logical and well-justified?
10 POINTS	Scalability & Future Potential
	- Can the solution be scaled or expanded beyond the hackathon prototype? - Does the team demonstrate future potential or practical deployment?

CATEGORY B: INNOVATION & CREATIVITY (30%)	
MAX POINTS	CATEGORIES
20 POINTS	Originality of Idea
	- How unique or creative is the solution? - Does it introduce new approaches or perspectives in solving the problem?
10 POINTS	Tool Use & AI Orchestration
	- Are external tools creatively integrated into the logic? - Does the technology enhance the uniqueness of the solution?

CATEGORY C: TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION (25%)	
MAX POINTS	CATEGORIES
15 POINTS	Agentic Architecture & Design
	- Does the team describe a clear agentic architecture? - Are the components of the solution logically structured?
10 POINTS	Prototype Functionality
	- Has the team built a working prototype or proof of concept? - Does the prototype demonstrate the core functionality of the solution?

Submission Guidelines

- The submitted solution must reflect the **team's original work**, completed during the hackathon duration.
- Solutions must leverage **LLM or AI technology** in addressing the problem statement.
- **Plagiarism** of ideas, code, or designs is **strictly prohibited**.
- Submissions must be made before the **deadline**; incomplete, illegible, or late submissions will not be considered.
- Submissions with offensive, illegal, or unethical content will result in **immediate disqualification**.

Submission Details

A google form will be sent to both Discord server and Instagram on 24 May 2026 (Sunday).

Phase 1: Preliminary Round Requirements

1. Pitch Deck (Max 10 Slides)

- A concise presentation outlining your problem statement, solution architecture, business value, and team composition.
- Excluding title and thank you slides.

2. Agent Framework Diagram

- Included directly within your Pitch Deck.
- Must clearly map out and visualize your agent workflow.

3. Video Demo (3–4 Minutes)

- A recorded walkthrough of your working solution.
- Focus on demonstrating the user experience and the underlying AI capabilities.

4. Source Code & Documentation

- A link to your public or shared repository.
- Must include a proper [README.md](#) file explaining:
 - System requirements and dependencies.
 - Clear, step-by-step instructions on how to install, configure, and run the application locally.

Phase 2: Grand Final Requirements

1. Enhanced Project

- Refined and improved source code incorporating feedback from the preliminary round.

2. Final Pitch Deck

- An updated, highly polished version of your pitch deck optimized for a live presentation to the grand panel of judges.

Awards & Recognition

- **Certificate of Participation** will be awarded to all participants who register under a team and successfully submit their project.
- **Cash prizes** will be awarded to the top three teams from a **total prize pool of RM3,000**:

First Place : RM 1,250

Second Place : RM 750

Third Place : RM 500

Special Price : RM 500

- **Finalist teams** will receive **exclusive AI Marathon finalist merchandise**, including custom event T-shirts and sponsored tech accessories.
- **Hackathon participants** will also receive **AI Marathon branded items** such as drawstring bags, lanyards, and stickers featuring AIC and sponsor logos as event memorabilia.

Contact Information

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